



Bendy backbone

A cheetah can only sprint for 20 seconds because it gets tired.

Speedy cat

Cheetahs are the only cats that run down their meals. They can sprint at 60 miles (100 km) per hour and are the fastest mammals.

Play fight

Baby cats, or kittens, are playful. They chase one another, jump into the air, and chew twitching tails! This is the way they learn to hunt.

Sensitive whiskers

The rough tongue can rub meat off bones!

Leopards are about 24 inches (60 cm) tall. They live in Africa and southern Asia.



Leopards sleep 16 hours a day, usually in short "cat naps."

Big cats roar; they can't purr.

Black leopards, or panthers, can be born to "yellow" parents.

Panthers are spotted, but their spots are hard to see!

Leopards live and hunt on their own. Groups of lions often gang up on them and steal their food.

Cats comb and clean their fur coat with their tongue.

Soft pads let cats creep quietly.



Really wild cat

There are more than 300 million pet cats in the world. They are believed to have been bred from wildcats over 12,000 years ago. This Scottish wildcat is much fiercer than a tame tabby!



Put your claws in!

Little muscles pull most cats' daggerlike claws into special pockets, to stop them from becoming dull.

